

A man and a woman are sitting on a brown leather couch in a dimly lit room. The woman, with long brown hair, is wearing a light pink, off-the-shoulder, short-sleeved dress. She is looking towards the camera with a slight smile. The man, with short dark hair, is wearing a black t-shirt and a silver watch. He is smiling and looking at the woman, with his hand resting on her shoulder. In the background, there are string lights and a table with red cups and a bottle. The overall atmosphere is intimate and romantic.

The After Party

Taken Erotica

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I knew maybe two of the people in our living room, and barely even them. Cass had filled the place like she always did when she was in a hosting mood, cheap string lights, mismatched chairs dragged in from the patio, a Bluetooth speaker on the counter, and a big plastic bowl of liquor punch she called “nurse fuel.” I brought and tried to stay out of the way, which was usually the unspoken arrangement. She handled the people, I made sure no one spilled on the carpet.

The first time I noticed him, he wasn’t doing anything loud, just standing in the kitchen entryway, talking to one of the girls from Cass’s program, a red cup in hand, smiling at whatever she said like he already knew where the conversation was headed. Black guy, probably a couple years older than me, built like someone who played a sport but didn’t need to talk about it. Calm and smooth, something about how comfortable he was in his own body made the rest of us look like we were still waiting for permission to exist.

Cass brought him over with two drinks. “Trey, this is Jared,” she said, touching my arm like I’d somehow wandered off. “Jared, this is Trey. He’s in that kinesiology elective I was telling you about.”

I shook his hand, warm grip, relaxed of course. “Hey,” I said.

He gave a slight nod, an easy smile. “Appreciate you guys having us over. Good energy in here.”

Cass beamed at that like the party had just passed some invisible test. She leaned in and said something else to him as I stepped back to the fridge. I wasn’t needed for the rest of that conversation.

There was music and people laughing, a couple girls dancing near the window like it was a bigger room than it was. Someone from her class had brought two bottles of wine and no corkscrew. Trey pulled one from his back pocket, said it was a habit. Everyone laughed.

Cass was bouncing between clusters of people, topping off drinks, making sure no one felt left out. She was wearing the silver dress with the

little bows at the shoulders, the one she said made her feel “hostessy,” and it showed more leg than she usually let outside the bedroom. She wasn’t trying to be flirtatious. She just lit up when she had a full room to orchestrate. And she looked good doing it.

I remained at the edge of it all, watching her pass him another drink before it was empty. I told myself it was just her being polite.

She perched on the arm of the couch next to him as the group around them laughed at something he said, her legs crossed and swaying gently. She looked happy and relaxed.

And when she touched his shoulder, just lightly, just for emphasis, and didn’t even glance in my direction.

I told myself it was nothing.

The way her hand stayed there, though, curled lightly into his shoulder while she laughed, that was just Cass being animated. She touched people when she talked. It didn’t mean anything. He was the one leaning in, grinning wider every time she said something clever, his eyes never drifting far from her mouth.

I stood by the counter sipping a drink I didn’t even want, pretending to be part of it all. Every now and then I’d catch someone’s eye and nod like I was following the story. But I was really just watching her legs, watching the hem of that dress creep higher each time she shifted her weight. Trey didn’t seem to be trying anything. He wasn’t all over her. But he kept her close.

By ten-thirty, people had started trickling out. One of the girls had an early shift, another was designated driver. Cass hugged them all at the door, thanked them for coming, promised to do it again soon. I stacked a few empties and brought them to the sink. When I turned back, there were only three people left, then after a few more minutes, it was just Trey, Cass, and me.

She didn’t act like anything had changed, though. She plopped down on the couch again beside Trey, tucking her bare legs under her and flashing me a smile like we were just winding down, like it wasn’t strange that I was across the room and she was curled up next to him like it was his apartment now too. She was animated with him discussing the ins and outs of everybody who was there.

She handed him her drink without asking. He took it with no hesitation, took a sip, made a face, and said, “You went easy on the rum this time.”

She laughed. "I'm pacing myself."

"That what you call this?" he teased, his voice low. "I though you were getting bolder."

Cass leaned back resting against the cushion now. "Oh really?" She had fun challenge in her eyes.

"Definitely," he said. "You were way more shy earlier."

Her smile twitched. "Was not."

"You were hiding behind your boyfriend."

At that, she glanced at me for a second, but long enough to make it clear they were talking about me. I gave a little smile, tight and uncertain, but I didn't move. I didn't speak.

"Maybe I'm just getting comfortable now," she said. "Ever think of that?"

"I can tell." He patted his leg. "Come here then if you're so comfortable."

It was a joke. It had to be. But she looked at him a moment, grinned, then swung her legs across his lap like it was nothing. Not fully seated, not straddling, but certainly perching. Half a joke, half a dare.

He didn't look at me and neither did she. It was like I wasn't even there. He said something quiet to her and she laughed, then swatted his arm and let her hand rest there again, her wrist pressed against his chest. She was still smiling but now she was flushed in her cheeks.

I watched her settle more into him, watched her shift her hips to get more comfortable on him. Her knee brushed his and she didn't fix her dress.

She didn't look my way and I didn't stop it. I told myself not to read into it, that it was just part of her playful side, the same way she'd joke with friends or tease her classmates when they crammed for finals. But that wasn't what this was, and I knew it the moment he let his arm fall behind her waist.

It wasn't possessive. That would've been easier to react to. It was relaxed, casual, like his hand had landed there because that's where it fell. She didn't flinch. She didn't even pause. She leaned back, shoulder against his chest, like they were deep into some conversation that required that kind of closeness.

The music was loud enough still I didn't hear anything. I remained in the armchair by the window trying to look like I wasn't paying attention, like this was all still normal. I told myself if she crossed a line, I'd do

something. If he did anything obvious, I'd say something. But everything happening was right on that edge, each touch small enough to deny, each moment soft enough to pretend it was still innocent.

They kept talking in low voices, smiling in that quiet, locked-in way people do when they've tuned the rest of the room out, laughing privately, murmuring jokes. She shifted her weight again, drawing her knees up beside her on the couch, which only pressed her deeper into his lap.

"You're not uncomfortable, are you?" he asked, grinning suspiciously.

She shook her head, almost laughing. "No, why?" she said equally suspiciously.

"Just making sure. You're in my space now I treat my guests right."

She rolled her eyes. "Please. You're the one taking up half the couch."

"That's because you're sitting on me."

"You wanted me to."

"You didn't have to do it."

Cass bit her lip and gave him a look that was half playful, half unreadable. Then she rested her hand on his thigh just above his knee, and left it there while she turned her head toward him to keep talking.

I felt like I was sinking into the chair. I couldn't get a full breath. Every time I thought about standing up, saying something, asking her to come sit next to me instead, I imagined how that would sound. Needy. Controlling. Insecure. I didn't want to be that guy, the guy who makes things weird just because his girlfriend's being friendly.

But this wasn't just friendly. I watched her fingers absently tap against his leg as they talked, she impatient, her bare shoulder brushing against his chest, her laugh coming softer now. She was sitting in his lap and it wasn't a joke anymore.

Trey's hand moved lower on her back easing into place, both of them getting more comfortable. And still, I sat there.

She didn't ask me with her eyes. She didn't check in. She just remained where she was, her body slowly molding into his like this was what the night had been leading toward all along.

I told myself it wasn't far enough to matter. But it was already too far to undo. The worst part was how normal it still looked. That's what kept me frozen: there was no scene to interrupt, no moment that could be called out without sounding insecure. She wasn't climbing on top of him. He wasn't pulling her dress off. It was just two people, two friends sitting close,

laughing softly, talking like everyone else had just stepped into another room.

But I knew that wasn't true. The party had ended twenty minutes ago. The room was quiet except for the music and the occasional rattle of ice shifting in a glass. And she was still on his lap.

Trey's hand slid lower, tracing around her waist now, moving along the side of her dress. His fingers weren't grabbing, they weren't groping, but they were there. Cass didn't say anything. She kept her eyes on him and smiled whenever he spoke, watched his mouth, darted her gaze from eye to eye.

I thought about saying her name, just that, nothing aggressive, just enough to pull her attention back to me. But even the idea of interrupting felt like stepping off a ledge.

She leaned forward, her hand on his chest now as she laughed at something he whispered. The movement pressed her body tighter to his. I could see the curve of her hip against his thigh, the edge of her dress caught against the seam of his jeans. It was all small things, friction, weight, her letting herself settle more.

She glanced at me, just a flick of the eyes, not checking in, more like checking to see if I was still watching. I was. I didn't look away. She held gaze for a moment, then turned back to him, like that had answered something for her.

Trey's voice dropped lower. I couldn't hear what he said, but her reaction was immediate, another small laugh, one she tried to hold back. She reached for her drink, took a sip, then set it back down without moving from his lap.

Her legs shifted, uncrossing, knees dropping open. I saw the hem of her dress ride higher. She didn't notice, or maybe she did and didn't care.

"You cold baby?" he asked her.

"A little," she said.

"Come closer, then."

She rolled her eyes, but she didn't argue. She adjusted herself on him, inching closer to his chest, her arm curling across his torso now, chin resting near his shoulder.

From where I sat, all I could see was her body and his hands, one resting at the small of her spine, the other now slowly rubbing her thigh.

She let him.

I watched her body respond, not dramatically, but in those small, steady shifts, the way her spine arched, the way her fingers curled against his shirt, the way her legs opened just a bit wider when his thumb brushed higher along her inner thigh.

She wasn't pulling away. She wasn't stopping anything. And I was still pretending not to notice.

He touched her knee. I watched it happen, his hand sliding down the length of her thigh, palm open, deliberate in a way that was careful but not shy. His fingertips brushed along the inside curve and settled just above the knee. Nothing that could be called overt, nothing that would get him kicked out of a party. But it was the kind of touch that assumed it was okay.

Cass didn't even twitch. She was still angled into him, half-twisted on his lap, talking softly. Her voice wasn't shaking. If anything, it had gotten steadier. She said something about the playlist, something about how she used to dance to this song in high school. He laughed and she laughed with him. The sound of it didn't match the heat gathering in her skin.

His hand moved again, this time along the outside of her thigh, then back across the top, brushing the edge of her dress where the hem clung tight to her. She pulled her legs up, adjusting how she sat, and in doing so she pressed herself more completely into him. Her thighs came together, tucking under her, but she didn't shift away. She looked at him, cheeks warm, mouth slightly open like she was trying not to smile.

He reached up and touched her shoulder. "You keep letting this fall," he said, thumb nudging the little bow at the top of her dress strap. "You coming onto me, girl?"

She chuckled. "I guess I just tied it bad," she said quietly.

"You sure you want it tied at all?"

"Shut up," she laughed lightly and she pinched his lips closed, but left her hand cupping his jaw, her fingers lightly on his lips.

She looked down at her drink. Her hand adjusted the fabric, not pulling it up, not fixing it, just grazing the edge where her skin had started to show too much. She looked at me again for a second, but long enough for me to register the flush in her cheeks and the way her hair had started to fall across her face.

I didn't say a word.

Trey leaned in a little, his lips close to her ear, and whispered something more. She bit the corner of her lip, the same way she did when she was

trying to suppress a real reaction. She planted her hand on his chest again, not to push him back, but to curl her fingers in his shirt

He let the strap slip farther. She watched it fall. Then she reached up and touched it herself, hesitating with her fingers at the loose bow. Trey didn't move. He let her decide. Her eyes flicked to mine again, and she paused like she was giving me the chance to say something, to shake my head, to do anything.

But I didn't.

Her hand dropped back to her lap, and the strap slid off her shoulder and hung loose.

Her skin caught the light in a way that made everything else in the room feel artificial, like the party lights and the furniture and even the music had all faded into background decoration. It was like she was under a stage spotlight. The strap hung down her arm, loose now, the round of her shoulder bare and newly unfamiliar. She remained rocking in his lap with her dress slipping lower, her thighs still tucked beside him, her hand resting gently on his chest.

Trey didn't take more than what she gave, but he didn't pretend not to see it either. His eyes moved slowly over her body, not groping or wide with surprise, but taking her in like he was finally seeing what he had been working toward. His hand returned to her side, smoothing along the fabric bunched at her waist, and then to the middle of her back where it settled firmly. The moment stretched in that way tension does when no one breaks the silence, when all three of us knew exactly what had changed and none of us moved to stop it.

Cass reached up and touched the other strap. She didn't untie it but her fingers played with it, looped it once around, then let it go. She looked at me again, and this time the look held longer, as if some small part of her was still taking the temperature. She wasn't asking for permission, but she wasn't pretending I didn't exist either. Her face was pink, her eyes wide and alert, but there was no apology in her expression, only breathless uncertainty and something behind it that looked like the early edge of want.

I waited for her to cover up. I waited for her to laugh, to play the joke, to pull the strap back up and make a crack about how warm the apartment had gotten. She didn't. She just turned back toward Trey and leaned into him more, pressed her cheek against his jaw, her arm now fully across his chest.

He spoke again, low in her ear, and this time I saw her smile, not because it was funny, but because whatever he said had slipped past all the usual defenses. Her body moved against his, her thigh shifting, her shoulder rising as she adjusted herself. She was moving closer.

Trey let his fingers trail up from her hip to the side of her chest, pausing just beneath the fabric, letting them rest there without pressure. Her breath hitched. She looked down at his hand, then back at his face, and said nothing, but she playfully pursed her lips and widened her eyes.

Her hand moved first. She reached for his wrist, not to stop him, but to hold it, like she wanted to feel the weight of it against her. The second strap slipped down.

Her dress fell down slowly, caught at first on the shape of her chest, before surrendering to gravity in small, revealing slips until the fabric gathered at her waist. Her hands remained in her lap, not covering herself, not reaching for the straps. She sat more upright in his lap, bare from the waist up, her breath quick and shallow but steady enough to make it clear this wasn't some accident she planned to undo. He must have untied it from behind her shoulder, like he did the first strap as well. She gave him a look of disappointment, before she stuck her tongue out at him.

I couldn't move. My chest was tight with it. I was sitting no more than six feet away, and I couldn't bring myself to speak. I wasn't even sure what I would've said if I had. There was no moment to interrupt, no sharp line that had been crossed, only the slow, seamless transition from flirtation into exposure, the kind that had slipped so naturally into place that calling it out would've made it feel real in a way none of us seemed ready to acknowledge out loud.

Trey looked at her like he had all the time in the world. He didn't rush to touch her. He didn't grope or paw her. He just looked with the kind of calm satisfaction that comes from knowing you've been invited to. His hand moved eventually, not to cup her breast, but to trace around it, the back of his fingers skimming the curve of her skin at the side of her breast like he was learning its temperature.

Cass's eyes fluttered but only for a moment. She wasn't looking at either of us now, she was focused inward, on sensation, on breath, on holding herself still while his fingers circled slowly around. Her mouth parted and she swallowed. She didn't try to say anything, because there was nothing

left to say. She had let him undress her, and now she was letting him explore her.

His hand moved closer, and when he brushed it across her nipple, her shoulders tensed just slightly, and pulled up. A quiet sound left her lips, not loud enough to be called a moan, but audible enough that I felt it like a pulse in my neck. Her hips shifted forward as if her whole body had taken that single touch inside. She leaned into him more fully now, one arm wrapped around the back of his neck, the other still resting in her lap.

Trey whispered something to her again. The tone was clear and gentle, coaxing and intimate. Cass gave a small nod, eyes half-lidded now. She reached up, touched his jaw, and tilted her head into the space where his mouth waited. When she kissed him, it wasn't fast or aggressive. It was slow and open-mouthed. She met it like she'd been waiting to find out how it would feel to kiss him like this, skin against skin, nothing between them anymore.

She kissed him like it was something they'd already done in her mind, something already overdue. There was no hesitation in the way her lips moved with his, no flinch when his hand returned to her breast, this time cupping it fully, his thumb tracing slow circles that made her hips stir. Her bare skin shifted against his shirt with every breath, the warmth between them turning visible now in the way she pressed her chest into his palm.

The music pounded and I couldn't stop watching. Every time I thought I would say something, stand, move, interrupt, the moment changed just enough to keep me stuck in my place. They weren't screwing on the couch. It was nothing loud or explicit. It was just two people pressed tightly together, kissing, touching, and a third, me, frozen in the corner, silently pretending it was all still reversible.

I felt encased in cement. My face felt like it had been plastered. Her hand slid across his stomach, curious, as though feeling the shape of him through his shirt. She slouched lower, her fingers resting just above his belt. His hand stayed on her chest while his mouth drifted from her mouth to her neck, then lower, pressing kisses along the slope of her shoulder and down to the edge of where her dress still clung around her ribs.

Cass tilted her head back, her eyes closed, and her lips parted. I watched her body respond to him with soft, involuntary shifts, her spine arching, her thighs flexing. Her skin flushed pink across her chest, and when he took her nipple into his mouth, she gasped.

It was sharp and real, one pure sound, the kind she makes when something catches her off guard, something intimate. The worse it got, the more I stiffened with paralysis. It was the music, it was beating so incessantly, the lights were dim, my mind swirled. It felt like I was the one who didn't belong.

She gripped the back of his head, holding him there, her fingers twisting into his hair as he sucked on her gently, one then the other. Her other hand, still resting on his belt, tugged slightly at the waist now, like she wanted him closer and didn't care I was right there, or forgot.

Trey pulled back just enough to look at her. "You're shaking baby," he murmured.

Cass gave a quiet, breathy laugh and touched her lips to his again. "You shouldn't, you know," she whispered.

"You good?"

She nodded, breathing hard. "Yeah. It's just . . ."

He waited.

"It feels so good," she breathed and she hid her face in his neck.

Trey's smile was soft and sure. He reached down then, one hand sliding between her thighs. She didn't stop him. She didn't even hesitate. She lifted her hips as he adjusted the hem of her dress, then eased it higher, exposing the white cotton of her panties. His fingers grazed the inside of her thigh, all of it slow and gentle, all of it by tiny increments.

I felt like I shouldn't watch. It felt like I couldn't tell if this was right for a girlfriend or not. My mind was like a tornado.

She leaned forward, forehead to his. He touched her down there, through the fabric. She gasped, softer this time, and her legs parted for him. Her hand stayed on his belt, her fingers curled and her nails scratched at his denim.

The sound she made when he touched her on the centre of her panties wasn't loud, but it hollowed something out in me. Her breath caught in her throat, her hips curled into his hand, and I saw her lose total track of where she was. Her focus narrowed completely to the feel of his fingers pressing through the thin fabric between her legs. Her head dropped, hair fell over her face, her shoulders curled in like she was trying to stay inside the sensation.

Trey didn't look at me. He had her attention, all of it, and he knew it. His hand moved slowly, his thumb dragging in slow, teasing strokes that made

her legs part even wider around his thigh, her back arching just enough to push her closer. She whispered his name, and the way it left her mouth, she'd given up trying to resist him in any way.

He kissed her again, one hand still working between her legs, the other sliding around to the small of her back. I could see her thighs trembling now. Her breath came faster, uneven, her hand gripping his shoulder like it was the only thing tethering her to the couch.

"I have to feel you," he said quietly.

She only nodded.

He slipped his fingers beneath the edge of her tight lace panties, slow enough that I could see the shape of them stretch before they gave way. Her whole body went still for a moment. She exhaled hard through her nose, then let out a low sound as his fingers touched her bare.

Her thighs opened wider on instinct.

I watched his hand move beneath the fabric rhythmically, his wrist turning as he found her, pressed her, circled her, slid inside her. Cass grabbed his forearm, her eyes squeezed shut, and her mouth dropped open as she tried to breathe through the building pressure.

I could see the change hit her face, her eyebrows drawing in, her chest tightening, her legs going rigid, then trembling again as her body pulsed around him. Her hand covered her mouth, muffling the quiet gasp that escaped her. She rode it out in silence, body pressed into him, her head buried against his neck.

He held her through it, murmuring things I couldn't hear, his hand slowing only after her grip on him began to loosen.

She hung draped across his lap, panting softly against his shoulder, one arm wrapped around the back of his neck, the other falling slack at her side.

When she pulled back, her eyes were glassy, lips parted, face flushed.

He kissed her again, soft and deep.

She didn't say anything and she didn't look at me. She only sat up straighter, pushed the straps of her panties down over her hips, and slid them off completely.

She stepped out of them one leg at a time, slow and steadily, folding the damp white cotton into her palm like she'd forgotten I was anywhere in the room, or maybe she remembered and had decided it didn't matter. She didn't hand them to him or toss them aside. She just set them on the arm of the couch, and settled back into his lap without a word.

I was already dead inside. I felt like a ghost. I felt like furniture, stiff, wooden and cold. My heart may have pounded, but my mind was slowing to nothing. I couldn't feel my legs or arms. I tried to open my mouth as though to say something, and couldn't get it to obey.

Her body was bare from the waist down now, the dress bunched high at her middle, barely covering her, and she was bare beneath that, too. Her skin was flushed, the insides of her thighs streaked with the glossy sheen of what he'd drawn out of her. Trey didn't move. He just calmly considered her like he was working on art, trying to commit to memory the way she looked in that exact moment, skin warm, chest rising, lips parted, her knees drawn wide as she straddled his thigh.

When he reached for his jeans, it was quiet and methodical. He unbuttoned them without looking down, pulling the zipper open while Cass watched, her hands now resting at the tops of her own thighs. She didn't move to help him but she calmly waited, her breath shallow, her eyes locked on to what he was about to show her.

He shifted under her and freed himself and I saw her eyes widen.

Even from where I sat, I could see it, thick, heavy, too large for any comfortable first glance. Her mouth parted and she gave a soft, nervous laugh, almost embarrassed by her own reaction to the size of it.

"Jesus," she whispered and she bit her lip.

Trey smiled but didn't say anything. His hand wrapped loosely around the base and he gave himself a slow stroke like he wanted her to see the full weight of it before inviting her to do anything.

I swallowed hard. I was afraid my heart would collapse. Trey lifted his eyes to mine, he grinned, and he gestured with his finger to his lips for me to say nothing. I was never more confused. I felt my soul leave my body and float up to the ceiling. What do I do? What do I do? screamed a voice over and over, me not even realizing that was me.

She reached out cautiously, fingers brushing his length at first like she wasn't sure where to begin. When she wrapped her hand around it, I saw the difference in scale, the way her grip couldn't close fully, how her thumb came nowhere near her fingers on the other side.

She looked up at him and dropped her mouth wide open, gave him her big shocked eyes. .

"Are you sure?" she murmured.

His voice was low, soft. "I want you to try."

Cass hesitated then she nodded. Her hand began to move, slow and carefully over him. Her eyes when from his member to his face as she stroked him, searching for the right pressure, the right pace. When he sighed, she adjusted, her other hand bracing against his leg as she leaned forward.

Her hair slid off her shoulder. She kissed the tip.

He groaned under his breath.

She kissed it again, lower this time, then opened her mouth and took him in, just the head, her lips stretched wide. She pulled back, caught her breath, then tried again, deeper this time, slower and with both hands now wrapped around the base as she worked her way farther down his length.

She didn't glance at me. I wasn't there.

She took her time with him. Her movements weren't rushed or clumsy, but they weren't hesitant either. She was teaching herself what he liked by feel alone. Her lips glided along his length in slow, wet passes, and each time she came up for air, she paused only long enough to grip him tighter, to swirl her tongue around the head, to ease back down with more of him than before. It wasn't just skill, it was intent. She wanted to please him, to feel him, to learn the shape of his body with her mouth.

His hand rested on the back of her head, guiding her, his fingers moving through her hair as if in rhythm with the slow pace she'd set. He watched her the entire time, quiet, focused, mouth slack in awe. Every now and then he murmured something, small words of encouragement, barely audible praise that made her hum around him and close her eyes harder, like it meant something to hear it from him.

I sat completely frozen across the room, watching the woman I thought I loved crouch between another man's legs, moaning softly as she pulled him deeper into her mouth with every stroke. Her bare thighs were parted, knees sinking into the couch cushion. Her dress had fallen behind her, forgotten now. Her back arched when she shifted, the muscles along her spine moving like waves as she adjusted her angle to take more of him in her mouth.

Trey exhaled through his teeth, his voice low and strained. "You're so fucking good at this, baby," and he chuckled. He looked up at me, and repeated himself, "She is so fucking good at it, you know what I mean?" He caressed her face, massaged her hair, and nodded at me.

I felt like I was made of paper.

She didn't answer him. She couldn't. Her lips were stretched wide, cheeks hollowing as she worked him with a rhythm that was almost hypnotic, up, down, twist, repeat. The wet sounds filled the room on top of the music. Her hand squeezed at the base while her tongue teased the underside. She was completely absorbed in the act.

At one point she pulled back, her lips shiny, breath catching, and she looked up at him.

"Too much?" she asked, a real question, innocence on her face.

He shook her head. "No., just right. You like it?"

Her eyes stayed on his. "Yeah," she said and she grinned coyly.

He smiled back, slow and warm. "Then don't stop, baby."

She didn't. She went back down on him with more focus, more energy, her strokes longer now, smoother, now with the kind of confidence that came from seeing the effect she was having on him. He moaned again, deeper this time, and his hips started to move, meeting her mouth as she bobbed over him.

She let him guide her. She let him use her mouth.

When he finally pulled her off, his hand cupping her cheek, she looked dazed, her breathing ragged, a string of spit still connecting them.

Trey wiped her mouth with his thumb, then leaned in and kissed her. Her lips were wet, her body flushed, and when he pulled her onto his lap, she straddled him like there was nowhere else she was supposed to be.

Her knees settled to either side of his hips as if she'd done it before. The kiss deepened slower, more drawn out than the first, her hands sliding to the back of his neck, fingers curling against the base of his skull. Her chest pressed into his, her breathing fast and shallow, her thighs tightening around him as she rocked forward.

Trey's hands moved along her naked sides, palms smoothing over her bare hips, the fabric of her dress still bunched behind her like an afterthought. He shifted beneath her and she lifted just enough for him to push his jeans down further. His erection rested against her, slick and hard between them. She looked down between their bodies and watched it slide against her belly, her hand reaching to guide him.

She gripped him with something close to awe, or a curious still, but certainly no longer shy. She stroked him once, twice, then positioned the head against herself. Her mouth parted as she shifted her weight forward in his lap.

I lost my breath. My blood drained from my head.

The first moment of contact stopped her. She froze, jaw clenched, and she pressed her forehead to his.

“You want it?” he asked again, quiet and close.

She nodded quickly. “Yeah,” she seemed to cry. “It’s just so big,” she whispered loud enough for me to hear. She darted a glance over her shoulder at me. I turned to ice.

He smiled and ran his hands slowly up her undulating back, his voice low and calm. “Just take your time. Go slow.”

Cass inhaled through her nose, then lowered her hips by degrees, every inch a negotiation with her body. Her mouth opened wider as he entered her, her fingers pressing into his shoulders, the tension in her legs tightening from resistance to embrace. She was breathing fast now, her eyes squeezing shut.

I watched her body shift and descend, watched her take him deeper with each soft exhale, until finally her hips settled all the way down on him and her thighs met his. Her entire posture trembled from the effort of taking him all the way in.

He was inside her, I could see it from behind her back. He held her there, hands steady on her hips, letting her adjust to it. Her breath caught again and again. She looked down at him, stunned, not by guilt or shame, but by the reality of what her body had just done. She had taken another man inside her, a much bigger man.

Trey kissed her neck, her shoulder, the edge of her jaw. He whispered something that made her smile through the tension.

Then she started to move. Her hips rolled slowly at first, short tight circles as she learned his rhythm, his shape. Her hands flattened against his chest, centering herself. Her moans were quiet, nearly voiceless, just vibrations in her throat. But I heard all of them. Every shift of her hips was smoother now, bolder.

She looked down at his face and kissed him again, deeper, sucking off his tongue in her mouth, her body beginning to rock with real momentum.

She rode him with the kind of focus I had never seen in her before, slow and certain, her hips rolling with purpose, not for his pleasure or mine, but something entirely her own. Her breathing stayed high and shallow, her thighs flexing with every motion. The way her hands moved over his chest

told me she was no longer thinking about what she was doing, only how it felt.

Trey let her move the way she wanted. He didn't rush her, didn't grab her or steer. His hands remained on her hips, his thumbs tracing the curve of her waist as she built her own pace. Every time her hips came down, he met her with just enough lift to keep her grounded in the motion. She wasn't bouncing, she was grinding, deep, slow, and wet, full with him, stuffed by him.

The sound of it filled the room. Her body meeting his with the faint slap of skin. Her breath exhaled through parted lips, then gasped when he lifted his hips more firmly into her. The couch creaked beneath them, a quiet, steady rhythm matched by the movement of her knees against the cushion.

Her head tilted back. Her hands moved to her own body now, one trailing across her chest, fingertips grazing the top of her breast, then circling one nipple until she shivered from the touch. Her other hand braced behind her, palm flat against his thigh, steadying her as she leaned back and changed the angle of her hips. Trey groaned low, and she moaned in response, her body settling deeper over him.

I didn't realize I was gripping the arm of my chair until my knuckles began to ache.

Her eyes opened briefly, glossy with heat and she smiled at him.

She leaned forward again, hands on his chest, and kissed him hard and frantic. Her body was working now with more rhythm, thighs pumping, the sound of her wetness undeniable. He slid a hand between them, his fingers finding her again, rubbing circles at the top of where they were joined. She gasped into his mouth.

"Oh God," she whispered, pulling back just enough to breathe.

"You gonna come again baby?" he asked.

She nodded, her movements stuttering as the tension in her thighs returned. Her fingers clawed at his shoulders and her rhythm started to unravel with less control and more need. She ground her hips hard into him now, chasing the edge with no care for how it looked or how it sounded. I could see it all from behind her, how wet everything was.

When it hit her, she collapsed forward, arms wrapped around his neck, body quivering as her voice caught in her throat. She buried her face in his shoulder, but her hips didn't stop moving, even as her moans turned to broken sighs and soft, whimpering gasps.

Trey held her tightly, kissing her neck, whispering again. She clung to him like she didn't want to come down from it.

And still she was moving. Even as her body trembled from the release, she didn't pull away. If anything, she sank deeper into him, grinding in slow, lingering circles. Her hands moved over his chest with new urgency, not clumsy or desperate anymore, but charged now with something more than curiosity, like having him inside her had unlocked a different kind of hunger. Her lips found his again, mouth open and searching, and he kissed her like he was just beginning.

Trey's hands were firmer now, gripping her hips with purpose, guiding her into a rhythm that matched his slow thrusts from beneath. He rocked up into her, deep and steady, and I watched her entire body lift and drop with his motion, her back arching as she adjusted to take him again and again. The wet sound of them filled the space between the creaking couch and her ragged breaths. He was ragdolling her.

She looked down, breathless, her face flushed and shining with sweat, her hair falling into her eyes as she braced her hands against his stomach. She was riding him now with dragging strokes that had her moaning softly each time he bottomed out.

"God, you feel so good," she murmured.

Trey grinned. "You're tight baby."

Cass bit her lip, her eyes fluttering closed as she moved harder, deeper. Her hands slid up his chest and locked behind his neck. She pulled him closer and whispered something into his ear, something I couldn't make out, but that made him groan and grab her ass, pulling her down onto him with more force now. Their bodies met with a sharper slap of skin, louder now, faster.

I could see everything, the muscles in her back, the way her hips twisted, the sheen along her thighs, the way her mouth dropped open as her body chased another climax. She rode him without apology, fully open, completely taken, and the more she gave herself over to it, the more beautiful she looked.

Her breath caught again, and her rhythm faltered. He knew.

His hand found her again, fingers between her legs, pressing, stroking, working her toward another release as his other arm wrapped around her waist. She gripped his shoulders, forehead pressed to his, and whispered his name like a plea.

She came hard, this time louder, messier, the kind of orgasm that emptied her lungs and curled her body tight to his. Her thighs shook. Her arms tightened. Her hips kept moving.

He was close now and she could feel it.

She felt him swelling inside her. I could see it in the way her rhythm changed, her hips slowing just enough to feel every inch of the new stretch, her movements syncing to the pulsing tension in his body as he neared the edge. Her face hovered just above his, lips parted, breath hot against his cheek, and her eyes stayed open now, watching him. She knew he was about to finish. She wanted him to. She adjusted her position to take him even deeper.

Trey gripped her hips harder this time, fingers digging into her skin as he thrust up into her with short, heavy movements. The calm confidence he'd held all night gave way to something more primal now, his voice low and ragged in her ear. She whispered back, words I couldn't hear, but the sound of them made him groan like she'd said exactly what he needed.

He lifted her, then slammed her back down onto him with a rhythm that grew faster and rougher. She gasped at the sudden force but didn't resist it. Her hands flattened against his chest and she braced herself as he used her body now with clear intent. She held herself open for him, her thighs stretched wide, her spine arching, her moans turning into short, broken sounds. She was being taken.

Trey's head fell back, his grip unrelenting, and I saw his body jerk once, twice.

He was coming inside her.

Her body tightened in response, hips pressing down to keep him deep, her breath catching as she felt the warmth flood into her. She didn't pull off, she remained still, trembling, letting him finish inside her, letting him empty everything into her without a word.

The room fell silent except for their breathing. The tension that had been stretching for what felt like hours finally broke, not with a crash, but with a slow settling. Cass slumped forward, chest to his, arms limp around his neck. Trey's hands softened at her sides, no longer guiding her, just holding her.

Neither of them spoke. She kissed his neck once, then let her forehead rest against his shoulder.

I sat in the same place I'd been since the beginning, unmoving, silent, my jaw clenched so tightly I wasn't sure if I'd be able to speak even if I tried. She had just let another man come inside her, slowly, deeply, completely, and she hadn't looked at me once during the whole thing, not for reassurance, not for permission, not for guilt.

She was still in his lap, his cock still inside her. I could see him run out of her. Her body twitched gently as she re-adjusted, and I saw her shift her hips to take one last deep breath against him before she finally lifted herself. A soft, wet sound followed, and his hands guided her down beside him.

She didn't speak. She moved slowly, carefully, like her legs weren't fully steady under her yet. Trey helped her ease down onto the couch beside him, his arm around her waist while she settled, the hem of her dress still bunched around her hips, exposing everything. Her skin was flushed and marked from where he'd held her, a faint pink line across her thigh where his fingers had gripped her too tightly. She didn't pull the dress down. She didn't reach for her underwear. She leaned against him and exhaled with her eyes closed, her face calm in a way I'd never seen after sex, not even with me.

Trey brushed her hair back and kissed her temple. She didn't flinch. Her hand found his knee and rested there. I could see the tips of his fingers still gliding over the inside of her thigh, slow, absentminded strokes.

I wanted to move, to stand, to make some sound that would remind her I was still there. But I didn't. My body felt like it didn't belong to me. I could feel the sweat drying at my temples, the tension in my chest burning like I'd been holding my breath for hours. I wanted to look away but I couldn't. I wanted to run, but it was like a dream where you can't move.

Trey leaned forward, kissed her neck, then stood. His cock hung heavy and slick as he tucked himself back into his jeans, his movements casual, like everything that had happened was just part of the night. He was shameless, remorseless. He pulled on his shirt without hurry and stretched, glancing around the room like he was getting ready to head out after a good hangout. Cass watched him with a soft, dazed smile. She hadn't moved to cover herself. She sat there naked, hair a mess, thighs wet with it, and didn't seem to care that I could see everything.

Trey grabbed his hoodie from the floor, slung it over his shoulder, and turned to look at me as though for the first time all night.

"You good?" he asked. There was no sarcasm. Just calm, a real question.

I didn't answer. I wasn't sure I could. What would I say?

He nodded like that was enough.

"She's a special one," he said, voice quiet. "But you already know that."

He looked back at her one more time. She was watching him now, still half lying on the couch, her fingers grazing the mark he'd left on her thigh.

"Get some rest," he said to her. Then he walked to the door and let himself out.

The latch clicked behind him. The hallway light spilled in for a moment, then vanished.

The silence after he left was total.

Eventually, she stood. She picked up her panties from the edge of the couch, looked at them for a moment, then carried them with her toward the bathroom. Her walk was slow, her legs shaky.

She closed the door behind her without a word. Water started running a moment later.

I stayed in the chair, not because I didn't want to move, but because I couldn't. The room had gone still, emptied of everything except the warmth left behind by what had happened, her body, his hands, the sounds they made together. There were pillows on the floor, a half-drunk glass of whiskey on the table, her panties folded in her hand as she'd walked to the bathroom like it was just part of cleaning up after a party.

I listened to the water run. The soft hiss of it behind the door was the only sound now, and it made the rest of the apartment feel hollow. I could picture her in there, standing under the stream, rinsing sweat and cum and whatever else from her thighs, her back against the tile. Maybe she was leaning on the wall. Maybe she wasn't thinking about me at all.

I stood finally and walked toward the couch. Her dress was still there, wrinkled and twisted, holding the shape of her body where it had been pulled tight across her hips. I touched the fabric but didn't pick it up. I saw a faint smear across the cushion, a mix of her and him, and I froze again, staring at it like if I looked long enough it might vanish. It didn't.

I crossed the room to the sink and rinsed my glass. My heart was still pounding.

The bathroom door opened. She stepped out wearing her robe. Her hair was damp, curling at the ends. She didn't look surprised to see me standing there.

She walked to the couch and sat again, pulling her legs up underneath her, robe tied loose, the skin of her thigh visible through the gap in the fabric. She stared at her hands for a while and then at the floor.

After a moment she looked up.

“We can’t talk about it, right?” she said. Her voice wasn’t cold, it was just quiet and steady.

I didn’t answer.

She nodded slowly to herself. She stood again, walked past me down the hall toward the bedroom, and left the light on behind her. I remained where I was.

The place still held everything. Her moans. His voice. The rhythm of her body above him. The look on her face when she came. But already it was drifting into the ether like it didn’t happen.

I turned off the music. The silence after was total. I picked up the glasses, closed the window, folded the blanket and laid it over the back of the couch, picked up the spilled cushions. I didn’t clean the spot where she’d sat. I didn’t touch that cushion. I wasn’t sure if I should or could.

I thought about what she’d rinsed off under the water, how long she’d stood there, whether she’d touched herself again, or just watched his cum slide down her leg and disappear into the drain.

The bedroom was dark except for the faint glow from her phone charging on the nightstand. She was already under the sheets, curled on her side, facing away from my side of the bed. Her hair was spread across the pillow, her bare shoulder rising with each breath. She didn’t say anything when I stepped in and she didn’t look at me.

I sat on the edge of the mattress. After a while, she spoke, barely louder than a whisper. “So seriously, we can’t talk about it, okay? He was my ex.”

I sat on the edge of the bed with my face in my hands contemplating the whole thing all over again from that completely new angle. At least it made more sense, the way she took to him, the way she knew what he liked, there was that. And my logical mind got involved, too: I knew she had an ex. I knew the sex was apparently good, if the relationship was not. I knew, now, she had sex with that man a lot before. So it wasn’t new, it was just a matter of timing, technically.

I was about to respond to her over my shoulder when she added, “Even if it happens again?”

Those words held in the air between us like cement. They weren't daring or cruel. They came across as simply honest. It was going to happen again, she was telling me. And we wouldn't talk about it.

I didn't answer. How could I?

I laid back beside her careful not to let our bodies touch. Her breathing remained even. She didn't repeat the question and she didn't press. She let it hang there, unanswered as though she thought I might need some time to consider it.

After a while, when she was now asleep, or pretending to be, I closed my eyes too. The scene played out on the back of my eyelids. Her hand reached across the void between us and found my hand and held it, squeezed it.

I squeezed her back and I wondered about myself until I fell asleep too.